

INDIVIDUAL TAX

Individual Tax Preparation Organizer

Organize expected documents, life changes, missing records, questions, and filing-readiness for the tax year.

Start with the year, not with the forms. The easiest way to identify missing documents is to think through what changed during the year: job changes, income, home or property activity, retirement, family changes, financial events, or tax notices.

Tax year	Taxpayer	Spouse, if applicable	Preferred contact

What changed this year?

- ☐ Marriage, divorce, new dependent, or dependent aging out
- ☐ Move, job change, retirement, or major income change
- ☐ Self-employment, new business, or platform / gig activity
- ☐ Home purchase or sale, investment activity, or education
- ☐ Childcare, other significant event, or unresolved tax notice

Change details and dates

Preparation context

A change does not automatically create a particular tax result. Record it so the preparer can determine what questions and documentation apply.

Expected income documents

The useful question is not just, "What do I have?" It is, "What should I expect based on what happened this year?"

Document / source	Expected?	Received	Corrected?	Still missing
Employment (W-2, wages, benefits)				
Retirement / government benefits				
Interest / dividends				
Brokerage / investment activity				
Self-employment / platform income				
Rental / property				
Other income source				
Other income source				

Source examples by type

Type	Examples to check
Employment	W-2, bonus statements, year-end pay records
Investment	Brokerage statements, dividends, capital gains records
Retirement	1099-R, pension statements, benefit records
Business / gig	Merchant statements, client payouts, expense records
Property	Rental summaries, sales statements, mortgage or property records

Use your actual sources

Examples are prompts, not a universal list. Build the expected-document list from the income and activity that applied to you this year.

Questions about an income record

Deductions, credits, and supporting records

Organize the records that explain why a line item exists. A good record is one that helps show the fact, the income source, the payment, or the event behind the question.

Category	Records located	Question / follow-up
Education / childcare		
Charitable giving		
Mortgage / property		
Health-related tax forms		
Retirement contributions		
Estimated payments		
State / local records		
Business or self-employment expenses		
Other potentially relevant records		

Prior-year return review

- ☐ Complete prior-year return is available
- ☐ Carryforward or recurring items noted
- ☐ Unresolved notices identified
- ☐ Estimated-payment history located

Record quality check

- ☐ The document is readable and complete
- ☐ The source is clear
- ☐ The year is clear
- ☐ The supporting record matches the relevant activity

Missing document tracker

When a required document is missing, do not guess from memory. Confirm whether it was expected, request the document or correction, and track the follow-up.

Missing item	Issuer	Date requested	Expected date	Status

When a document is missing

1. Confirm whether the document was expected. 2. Check the issuer portal or account. 3. Request the replacement or correction. 4. Record the request date and any follow-up. 5. Tell the preparer if the item is still pending.

IRS / state correspondence

Agency / notice type	Notice date	Deadline	Action taken	Needs review?

Corrected documents

Keep a simple record of what was received, what was corrected, and what changed. A corrected document can affect the final return and should not be assumed to match the original.

Final readiness

Before sharing information, confirm the records are complete, organized, and understandable. The goal is not to send everything. It is to send the records that explain the facts and the questions.

- ☐ Expected income records reviewed
- ☐ Life changes documented and missing records tracked
- ☐ Estimated payments and prior-year return identified
- ☐ Notices included and questions written down
- ☐ Secure sharing method confirmed
- ☐ Direct-deposit information will be provided only through an approved method

Questions for preparation

Questions and facts to review

After filing

- ☐ Retain the final return and supporting documentation
- ☐ Record carryforward, recurring, and next-year improvement notes

Next-year improvement notes

Security reminder

Do not send Social Security numbers, banking information, tax returns, identification documents, or other sensitive records through an unsecured contact form or ordinary email. Use only an approved secure method when instructed.

Next step

Need help organizing tax preparation? Schedule a consultation at getalchemize.com.

This organizer provides general preparation guidance. It does not determine tax treatment, guarantee a refund or other outcome, or replace advice based on current law and your facts.